

Barrier Reef anemonefish

Amphiprion akindynos

two black-edged white bands encircle body



Also known as clownfish, Barrier Reef anemonefish live in groups among anemones in reef waters up to 80 ft (25 m) deep. All anemonefish are born male, but some change to females as

required. The largest fish in a group becomes the dominant female and the second-largest, her mate. When the female dies, the dominant male changes sex to take her place.

- ↔ 2–5 in (5–13 cm)
- ⚖ 1 oz (28 g)
- ⊗ Not known
- 🌿 Algae, zooplankton
- 🏠



SW. Pacific
Ocean (Coral Sea)



SAFE SHELTER

By blending anemone mucus into their skin's own mucus coating, anemonefish avoid stings—and predators.

Peacock mantis shrimp

Odontodactylus scyllarus

- ↔ 1–7 in (2.5–18 cm)
- ⊗ Not known
- 🦀 Crabs, gastropods, fish
- 🏠



Indo-Pacific oceans

Peacock mantis shrimp are as complex as their colors. Their compound eyes have 12 different color photoreceptors (humans have three), which process infrared, ultraviolet, and polarized light, and they communicate using muscle-generated vibrations. Their “smasher” claws generate underwater explosions that can crack aquarium glass.



hinged smasher
folded against body

DEADLY STRIKE

Peacock mantis shrimp disable prey with a clublike “smasher” claw using the fastest measured strike in the animal kingdom. The quick strike vaporizes water on impact.